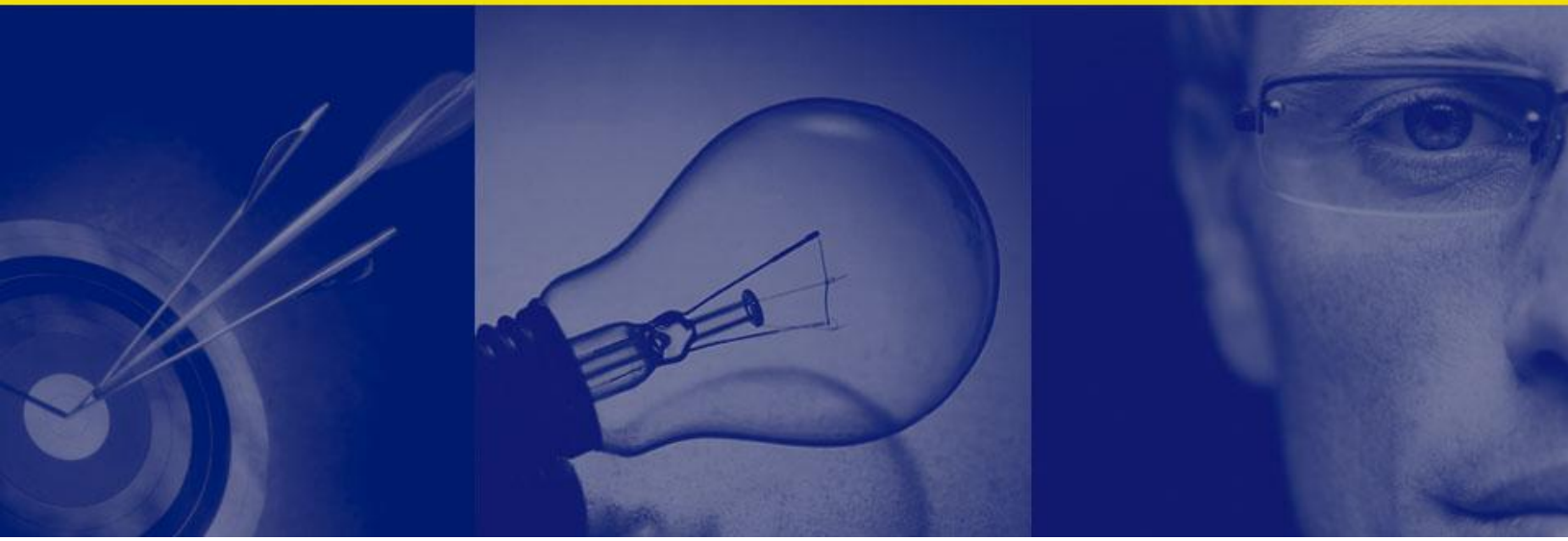
QUEST SOFTWARE®

Quest® Migration Manager 8.3 for Active Directory

Competitive Comparison vs. Microsoft ADMT 3.1



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Quest Migration Manager for Active Directory
Updated – February 1, 2009
Software version – 8.3

ABSTRACT

This document provides an overview of Microsoft Active Directory Migration Tool (ADMT) 3.1 and a comparison of it with Quest® Migration Manager™ for Active Directory 8.3.

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SUMMARY

Active Directory Migration Tool (ADMT) is Microsoft's tool for Active Directory migration. While being a sufficient tool for relatively small migration projects, the tool is difficult to use for medium- and large-scale migrations.

A solution for Active Directory migration should meet the following requirements:

- Complete automated data migration and resource update to minimize manual effort by administrators
- Minimal impact to end users to ensure no disruption of the production environment
- Control over the migration process

Using ADMT in medium and large migrations is impractical because it:

- Supports only a limited set of Active Directory configurations
- Migrates a limited set of directory data
- Cannot synchronize directories
- Updates only limited types of resources
- Does not provide statistics information on the migration project
- Does not provide rollback functionality in case of mistakes

Quest Migration Manager is designed specifically for complex migration projects and includes number of unique features, such as:

- Complete directory data migration
- Real-time directory synchronization
- Complete resource update of workstations and servers
- Detailed statistics for the migration project
- Complete undo capability
- Complete post-migration cleanup

FEATURE ANALYSIS

Project Management

FEATURE	MIGRATION MANAGER	ADMT	COMMENT
Continuous synchronization	Yes	No	Since migration can last for a long time, migrated data might become obsolete and need to be updated. To address this, ADMT performs remigrations throughout the process with different options. This means that it is necessary to repeat the same actions every day, requiring more time and manual effort. Migration Manager greatly simplifies this task, providing real-time directory synchronization and ensuring that critical data is kept up to date. Additionally, Migration Manager also provides two-way synchronization, making it possible to manage both directories simultaneously. This is especially critical for keeping passwords and group memberships up to date between the two environments.
Statistics	Yes	No	Migration Manager Statistics Portal gives you detailed information about the migration project.
Undo	Complete	Limited	Migration Manager allows you to revert any performed changes at any time without restoring data from backup. ADMT cannot roll back resource updating tasks. Directory migration undo is restricted to the last session only; account merging cannot be undone.

Directory Migration

FEATURE	MIGRATION MANAGER	ADMT	COMMENT
Inter-forest migration	Non-destructive	Non-Destructive	ADMT cannot roll back resource updating tasks. Directory migration undo is restricted to the last session only; account merging cannot be undone.
Intra-forest migration	Non-destructive	Destructive	In case of intra-forest migration, ADMT deletes a source account and its tombstone immediately after moving it to the target domain. Functionality to roll back this operation is not provided – it is necessary to re-migrate the account and workstation from the target back to the source.
Site topology migration	Yes	No	Migration Manager allows you to migrate network topology configuration including sites, subnets, and site links.

Migration without trusts	Yes	No	In some organizations, trusts between source and target domains cannot be established due to security reasons. Unlike ADMT, Migration Manager allows migration in this case.
Advanced object selection capabilities	Yes	No	ADMT uses a standard "select users and groups" dialog for object selection. It shows objects in flat list and doesn't allow filtering of disabled, expired, or system accounts.
Property population rules	Yes	No	Migration Manager lets you modify any object properties before the migration data is actually applied to the target domain, using import file technology. It allows you to populate values from an HR database or according to some other rules. ADMT does not allow you to modify all object properties, only the Container Name (CN), Relative Distinguished Name (RDN), sAMAccountName and userPrincipalName.
Security descriptor migration	Yes	No	If administrative rights are delegated on the OU level and you plan to preserve the existing delegation model after migration, security descriptors of OUs and accounts should be migrated. ADMT does not migrate security descriptors, and all permissions must be granted manually.

Resource Updating

FEATURE	MIGRATION MANAGER	ADMT	COMMENT
Consolidated resource updating	Yes	No	If you migrate multiple domains, resources should be updated for users from all domains. With ADMT, you have to update the same resources multiple times, separately for each source-target domain pair.
Workstation update	Complete	Limited	Migration Manager provides complete user workstation update. Whereas ADMT requires a reboot of the workstation in order to complete migration, only a logoff/logon is needed with Migration Manager. When migrating the workstation with Migration Manager, you can automatically change the default domain name on the workstations' logon prompt, making the switch invisible to users. In contrast to ADMT, it also includes update of scheduled tasks and migration of certificates for encrypted files and mail.

Laptop update	Yes	No	Usually laptops are disconnected from the corporate network and cannot be updated as ordinary workstations. Migration Manager allows you to update laptops via user logon scripts and without additional interaction with users.
Server infrastructure update	• Active Directory • Exchange 5.5/2000/2003/2007 • SharePoint Services 2.0/3.0, SharePoint Portal Server 2003/2007 • Internet Information Services 5.0/6.0 • SQL Server 7.0/2000/2005 • Systems Management Server 2003/System Center Configuration Manager 2007 • NAS/SAN devices	• Exchange 5.5	ADMT has incomplete server resource updating. It requires a great deal of administrator effort because all permissions must be updated manually.
Clean-up SIDHistory	Yes	No	To preserve network security, the SIDHistory attribute of objects should be cleaned up after migration. ADMT does not provide this functionality.